“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 23

Divine Love

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I take refuge in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, the supremely generous, who gave to all people, down to the lowest, the nectar of His own love and His name — His own hidden treasure, not given for a long time.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 Now hear of the fruit of *bhakti*: *prema*, the ultimate goal (*prayojana*). By hearing of it one comes to know *bhakti-rasa*.

4 When *rati* for Kṛṣṇa deepens, it is called *prema*. It is called the abiding emotion (*sthāyī-bhāva*) of the *rasa* of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

5 “That which by nature is a special *śuddha-sattva*, pure spiritual existence, which is like a ray of the sun of *prema*, and which by its tastes (*ruci*) softens the heart, is called *bhāva*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.1)

6 These two are the essential (*svarūpa*) and marginal (*taṭastha*) characteristics of *bhāva*. Now, Sanātana, hear the characteristics of *prema*.

7 “When *bhāva* has completely softened the heart, is marked by an intense feeling that ‘He is mine’ (*mamatva*), and has become dense in its nature, the wise call it *prema*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.1)

8 “The exclusive feeling ‘He is mine’ (*ananya-mamatā*) toward Viṣṇu alone, joined with *prema* — this is what Bhīṣma, Prahlāda, Uddhava and Nārada call *bhakti*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.2)

9 If by some good fortune faith (*śraddhā*) arises in a *jīva*, that *jīva* seeks the company of *sādhus*.

10 From the company of *sādhus* come hearing and chanting (*śravaṇa-kīrtana*), and by *sādhana-bhakti* all *anarthas* are removed.

11 When the *anarthas* have been removed, steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) in *bhakti* arises. From steadiness, taste (*ruci*) for hearing and the other practices is born.

12 From taste comes deep attachment (*āsakti*) to *bhakti*, and from attachment the sprout of love for Kṛṣṇa is born in the heart.

13 When that *rati* deepens, it takes the name *prema*. That *prema* is the ultimate goal (*prayojana*), the abode of all bliss.

14 “First comes faith, then the company of *sādhus*, and then the practice of worship (*bhajana-kriyā*). From it comes the removal of *anarthas*, then steadiness, and after that taste.

15 “Then come attachment and *bhāva*, and then *prema* arises. This is the order in which *prema* appears in those who practise *sādhana*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.15–16)

16 (Lord Kapila to His mother Devahūti:) “In the company of the saints there are talks revealing My power, delightful to the heart and to the ear. By relishing them one quickly comes to faith in Me, the path of liberation, and after it to attraction (*rati*) and love (*prema-bhakti*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.25)

17 All the scriptures describe these signs in one in whose heart this sprout of *bhāva* has appeared.

18–19 “Forbearance, never wasting time, detachment, freedom from pride, firm hope (*āśā-bandha*), eager longing (*samutkaṇṭhā*), a constant taste for singing the holy name, attachment to describing His qualities and love for the places where He dwelt — these and other *anubhāvas* are seen in a person in whom the sprout of *bhāva* has arisen.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.25–26)

20 One in whose heart this new sprout of love has appeared is not disturbed by anything worldly.

21 “O *brāhmaṇas*, and you, goddess Gaṅgā, know me as one who has surrendered, whose heart is fixed on the Lord. Let a magic creature sent by the *brāhmaṇa*, or Takṣaka himself, bite me as it will — you go on singing the narrations of Viṣṇu.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.19.15)

22 Not a moment of his time is wasted without connection with Kṛṣṇa. Worldly enjoyment, mystic powers and the objects of the senses do not appeal to him.

23 “Constantly praising Him with words, remembering Him with the mind and bowing down to Him with the body, the devotees are still not satisfied. With tears flowing from their eyes, they offer their whole life to Hari alone.” (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 12.38)

24 “Longing for Uttamaśloka, Bharata gave up, while still young, like so much filth, his wife and sons, his friends and kingdom — all dear to his heart and so hard to give up.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.14.43)

25 Though he is the best of all, he considers himself lowly, and he knows firmly that Kṛṣṇa will show him mercy.

26 “This crest jewel of kings, bearing *rati* for Hari, wandered begging alms in the city of his enemies and offered respect even to a dog-eater.” (Padma Purāṇa)

27 “I have no *prema*, no *bhakti* of hearing and the rest, no Vaiṣṇava *yoga*, no knowledge, no pious deeds — alas, not even a good birth. Yet, O Beloved of the *gopīs*, my hope in You, who grant the lowly more than they deserve, has roots that cannot be cut, and it torments me — alas, alas!” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.35)

28 In eager longing (*samutkaṇṭhā*) craving always predominates. Having a constant taste for singing the name, he chants the name of Kṛṣṇa.

29 “O flute-player, know that Your boyish charm and My restlessness are wonders of the three worlds, known only to You and Me. What then shall I do to gaze on Your charming lotus face with My own eyes, when We are alone?” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 32)

30 “O Govinda, today this young girl, Her blue-lotus eyes shedding drops of tears like honey, sings the string of Your names in a sweet voice.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.3.38)

31 He is always attached to describing Kṛṣṇa’s qualities, and he always lives in the places of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes.

32 “Sweet, sweet is the form of this Lord; sweet, sweet is His face — so sweet! And this soft smile, fragrant with honey — oh, it is sweet, sweet, sweet, sweet!” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 92)

33 “O lotus-eyed Lord, when shall I dance on the bank of the Yamunā, chanting Your names with tears in my eyes?” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.156)

34 I have described these signs of *rati* for Kṛṣṇa. Now, Sanātana, hear the signs of love for Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-prema*).

35 Even the wise cannot understand the words, actions and ways of one in whose heart love for Kṛṣṇa has risen.

36 “The ways of the fortunate soul in whose heart this new *prema* has blossomed are very hard to understand, even for those who know the scriptures.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.4.17)

37 “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)

38 As *prema* gradually increases, it becomes *sneha*, *māna*, *praṇaya*, *rāga*, *anurāga*, *bhāva* and *mahābhāva*.

39 It is like the seed, the sugarcane, its juice, molasses, raw sugar, refined sugar, white sugar, sugar candy, rock candy and pure rock candy.

40 Just as these become purer step by step and their taste increases, so the relish of *rati*, *prema* and the rest increases.

41 According to the differences among those qualified for it, *rati* is of five kinds: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*.

42 These five *sthāyī-bhāvas* become the five *rasas*, in which the devotee is happy and Kṛṣṇa comes under his control.

43 When the *sthāyī-bhāva* — *prema* and the rest — meets with its ingredients (*sāmagrī*), devotion to Kṛṣṇa is transformed into *rasa*.

44 *Vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī*: when these four combine with it, the *sthāyī-bhāva* becomes *rasa*.

45 When yogurt is mixed with sugar, black pepper and camphor, it becomes the drink called *rasālā*, whose taste is like nothing else.

46 *Vibhāva* is of two kinds: the support (*ālambana*) and the stimulus (*uddīpana*). The sound of the flute and the like are *uddīpana*; Kṛṣṇa and others are *ālambana*.

47 The *anubhāvas* are smiling, dancing, singing and other outward signs (*udbhāsvara*). Being stunned (*stambha*) and the rest, the *sāttvika* emotions, are counted among the *anubhāvas*.

48 Despondency (*nirveda*), joy (*harṣa*) and the rest are the thirty-three *vyabhicārī-bhāvas*. When all these combine, *rasa* becomes wonderful.

49 *Rasa* is of five kinds: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*. In *madhura-rasa* the amorous mood (*śṛṅgāra*) predominates.

50 In *śānta-rasa*, *śānti-rati* develops as far as *prema*; *dāsya-rati* gradually increases as far as *rāga*.

51 *Sakhya-rati* and *vātsalya-rati* reach the limit of *anurāga*. In Subala and his companions the glory of *prema* extends as far as *bhāva*.

52 The *rasas* beginning with *śānta* have two divisions, union (*yoga*) and separation (*viyoga*). In *sakhya* and *vātsalya*, union and separation have many subdivisions.

53 The *bhāvas* called *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha* are found only in *madhura-rasa*: *rūḍha* in the queens, and *adhirūḍha* in the *gopīs*.

54 *Adhirūḍha-mahābhāva* is of two kinds: in union it is called *mādana*, and in separation *mohana*.

55 In *mādana* there are endless varieties, such as kissing. *Mohana* has two divisions: *udghūrṇā* and *citra-jalpa*.

56 *Citra-jalpa* has ten parts, named *prajalpa* and so on. The ten verses of the *Bhramara-gītā*, the Song to the Bee, are the evidence of this.

57 *Udghūrṇā* and helpless actions (*vivaśa-ceṣṭā*) are called divine madness (*divyonmāda*). In separation Kṛṣṇa appears before her, and she even takes herself to be Kṛṣṇa.

58 *Śṛṅgāra* is of two kinds, union (*sambhoga*) and separation (*vipralambha*). Union has endless aspects; there is no end to them.

59 Separation (*vipralambha*) is of four kinds: longing before meeting (*pūrva-rāga*), loving pique (*māna*), separation by distance (*pravāsa*) and the feeling of separation even in the beloved's presence (*prema-vaicittya*).

60 *Pūrva-rāga*, *pravāsa* and *māna* are well known in Rādhikā and the other *gopīs*; *prema-vaicittya* is seen in the queens, as the Tenth

Canto describes.

61 (The queens of Dvārakā:) “O kurarī bird, you lament without sleep and do not even lie down, while at night the Lord sleeps in this world, His awareness hidden. Can it be, O friend, that like us you have had your heart deeply pierced by the generous, playful glance and smile of the lotus-eyed one?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.90.15)

62 Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is the crest-jewel of heroes (*nāyaka*), and Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the crest-jewel of heroines (*nāyikā*).

63 “Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, is the crown jewel of all heroes, for in Him all great qualities shine eternally.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.17)

64 “The goddess (*devī*) Rādhikā is declared to be full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*). She is the supreme deity; all the Lakṣmīs are within Her; She is the whole of splendour (*sarva-kānti*) and the supreme enchantress.” (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)

65 Kṛṣṇa’s qualities are endless, and sixty-four of them are principal. The devotees’ ears are soothed on hearing of each one of them.

66 “This hero (1) has beautiful limbs, (2) bears all auspicious marks, and is (3) delightful to see, (4) radiant, (5) strong and (6) ever youthful.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.23)

67 “He (7) knows many wondrous languages, (8) is truthful in speech and (9) speaks pleasantly; He is (10) eloquent, (11) deeply learned, (12) intelligent and (13) brilliantly quick-witted.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.24)

68 “He is (14) artful, (15) clever, (16) expert, (17) grateful and (18) firm in His vows; (19) He knows what befits place, time and person; (20) He sees through the eye of scripture; He is (21) pure and (22) self-controlled.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.25)

69 “He is (23) steadfast, (24) restrained, (25) forgiving, (26) grave, (27) composed, (28) equal to all, (29) generous, (30) righteous, (31) heroic and (32) compassionate, and (33) He honours those worthy of honour.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.26)

70 “He is (34) courteous, (35) humble and (36) bashful; (37) He protects the surrendered; He is (38) ever happy, (39) the friend of His devotees and (40) subdued by love; and (41) He does good to all.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.27)

71 “He is (42) mighty, (43) famous, (44) loved by the people, (45) the shelter of the saintly, (46) the captivator of women’s hearts, (47) worshipped by all and (48) supremely opulent.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.28)

72 “He is (49) the greatest of all and (50) the Lord. These fifty qualities of Hari have been proclaimed; like oceans, they are unfathomable.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.29)

73 “Although these qualities are at times found in living beings, there they are only tiny drops; in complete fullness they shine only in the Supreme Person (*Puruṣottama*).” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.30)

74 “Now there are five qualities that exist in part in Śiva and others: (51) He is always established in His own nature (*svarūpa*), (52) He knows all, and (53) He is ever new.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.37)

75 “(54) His limbs are concentrated being, consciousness and bliss — His form is dense consciousness and bliss; and (55) all perfections are under His control and serve Him.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.38)

76 “Now five qualities are described that are present in the Lord of Lakṣmī (Nārāyaṇa) and His other forms: (56) He has inconceivable great power, and (57) His body holds millions of universes.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.39)

77 “(58) He is the seed of all the *avatāras*; (59) He grants liberation to the enemies He slays; (60) He attracts even the self-satisfied (*ātmārāma*). In Kṛṣṇa these qualities are truly wondrous.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.40)

78 “(61) He is an ocean whose waves are pastimes that astonish even all wonders; (62) the circle of His beloved ones is adorned with incomparable, sweet love.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.41)

79 “(63) The sweet call of His flute attracts the minds of the three worlds; (64) the beauty of His form, which none can equal or surpass, astonishes all beings, moving and unmoving.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.42)

80 “His pastimes, the abundance of beloved ones bound to Him by love, and the sweetness of His flute and of His form — these four are declared to be Govinda’s unique qualities. Thus sixty-four qualities of four kinds have been described.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.43–44)

81 Śrī Rādhikā’s qualities are endless, and twenty-five of them are principal. By these qualities Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, is brought under Her control.

82 “Now the chief qualities of the Queen of Vṛndāvana are glorified. She is (1) sweet and (2) ever youthful; (3) Her sidelong glances are restless, and (4) Her smile is radiant.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 11)

83 “(5) She is rich in beautiful lines of good fortune; (6) Her fragrance maddens Mādhava; (7) She is expert in the wide art of song; (8) Her speech is charming; (9) She is skilled in playful jesting (*narma*).” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 12)

84 “She is (10) modest, (11) full of compassion, (12) artful, (13) skilful, (14) bashful, (15) ever keeping to what is proper, (16) steadfast and (17) grave.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 13)

85 “(18) She is rich in graceful pastimes; (19) She thirsts for the highest excellence of *mahābhāva*; (20) She is the abode of the love of Gokula; (21) Her fame shines throughout the ranks of all the worlds.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 14)

86 “(22) Her elders bestow great affection on Her; (23) She yields to the loving friendship (*praṇaya*) of Her companions; (24) She is the chief of Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds; (25) Keśava is ever obedient to Her.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Rādhā-prakaraṇa, 15)

87 The hero and the heroine are the two supports (*ālambana*) of *rasa*, and the best of these two are Rādhā and the son of the king of Vraja.

88 In the same way, in servitude the servants and in friendship the friends are its supports. Now hear the characteristics of how *rasa* arises.

89–91 “Their faults have been washed away by devotion, and their hearts are clear and bright. They are attached to the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam and delight in the company of *rasikas*. The wealth of happiness in devotion to Govinda’s feet has become their very life, and they perform only those practices that are intimate to *prema*. In the hearts of such devotees *rati* shines — bliss by its very nature, illumined by two kinds of impressions (*saṁskāra*), past and present — and it is brought to the state of *rasa*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.7–9)

92 “When Kṛṣṇa and the other *vibhāvas*, and the other ingredients of *rasa*, have entered the path of experience, this *rati* becomes mature bliss and reaches the highest limit of wonder.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.10)

93 Non-devotees have no taste of this *rasa*; it is the devotees of Kṛṣṇa who relish *rasa*.

94 “This *rasa* of the Lord is in every way inaccessible to non-devotees; it is relished only by devotees for whom His lotus feet are everything.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.131)

95 Thus I have briefly described the goal (*prayojana*). This love for Kṛṣṇa is the fifth goal of human life (*pañcama-puruṣārtha*), the greatest wealth.

96 Earlier, at Prayāga, I infused power into your brother Rūpa so that he could expound *rasa*.

97 You too must spread the scriptures of devotion and recover the lost holy places of Mathurā.

98 Service to Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana and the conduct of Vaiṣṇavas — compose a scripture of devotional law (*bhakti-smṛti*) about them and spread it.

99 He taught him everything about the standing of fitting renunciation (*yukta-vairāgya*) and altogether forbade dry renunciation and dry knowledge.

100–101 “One who bears no hatred toward any being, who is friendly and compassionate, free from the sense of ‘mine’ and from false ego, equal in sorrow and joy, and forbearing; who is ever content, a *yogī*, self-

controlled and firm in resolve, with mind and intelligence fixed on Me — such a devotee of Mine is dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.13–14)

102 "One by whom the world is not disturbed and who is not disturbed by the world, who is free from elation, intolerance, fear and anxiety — he too is dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.15)

103 "My devotee who expects nothing, who is pure and expert, unconcerned and free from distress, and who has given up all self-seeking undertakings, is dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.16)

104 "One who neither rejoices nor hates, neither grieves nor desires, who has given up both the auspicious and the inauspicious, and who is full of devotion — he is dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.17)

105–106 "One who is the same to foe and friend, the same in honour and dishonour, in cold and heat, in joy and sorrow; who is free from attachment; to whom blame and praise are alike; who is restrained in speech and content with whatever comes; who has no fixed home, whose mind is steady and who is full of devotion — such a person is dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.18–19)

107 "But those who, full of faith and holding Me as the highest, devotedly follow this nectar of *dharma* as I have declared it — such devotees are exceedingly dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 12.20)

108 "Are there no rags lying on the road? Do the trees, which sustain others, no longer give alms? Have even the rivers dried up? Are the caves closed? Does the Unconquerable Lord not protect those who take refuge in Him? Why, then, do the wise serve those who are blinded by the pride of wealth?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.2.5)

109 Then Sanātana asked about all the conclusions of the scriptures (*siddhānta*), and the Lord told him all the hidden conclusions of the Bhāgavata.

110 The Harivaṁśa tells of His eternal abiding in Goloka, at the time when Indra came and offered prayers to Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

111–112 The pastime of the clubs (*mauṣala-līlā*), Kṛṣṇa's disappearance, the "hair-*avatāra*" (*keśāvatāra*) and other contrary explanations, the abduction of the queens and so on — all these are illusory (*māyā-maya*). The Lord taught how to explain them so that they accord with the right conclusion (*siddhānta*).

113 Then Sanātana clasped the Lord's feet and, holding a bunch of straw between his teeth, made this submission:

114 "I am low-born, a servant of the low, utterly wretched — yet You have taught me conclusions beyond the reach even of Brahmā.

115 What You have spoken is an ocean of the nectar of conclusions; my mind cannot touch even a single drop of it.

116 If it is Your wish to make a lame man dance, then place Your feet on my head and give me Your blessing.

117 Bless me thus: 'May all that I teach you manifest in you.' This blessing of Yours will be my strength."

118 Then Mahāprabhu placed His hand on Sanātana's head and gave him the blessing: "May all this manifest in you."

119 Thus I have briefly told the account of *prema* as the goal (*prayojana*). The Lord's grace cannot be told in full.

120 Whoever hears the nectar of the Lord's teachings soon attains the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

121 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.